

EEF Meeting Minutes, Thursday May 27, 2021

Erlang Ecosystem Foundation, Minutes of a Regular Meeting of the Board of Directors Meeting #50, May 27, 2021

A regular meeting of the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation was held over group conference call (Zoom). The meeting began at 16:04 UTC.

Attendance

The following members of the board of directors were present (10/11): Sophie DeBenedetto, Richard Carlsson, Maxim Fedorov, Frédéric Trottier-Hébert, Kenneth Lundin, Peer Stritzinger, Sebastian Strollo, Bryan Paxton, Miriam Pena Villanueva, and Alistair Woodman.

Agenda Items

1. Vote of the minutes of the previous meeting.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the minutes as presented as representing a true and accurate record of the board meeting #49 held on May 13, 2021. Unanimously approved.

2. Intermediate actions: none
3. Treasury report: University of Milano finally received the payout for the ROSIE stipend. Membership update: Annual Supporting members: 130 (+3), Lifetime Supporting members: 13 (unchanged), Basic members: 700 (+38).
4. No unanimous consent vote scheduled.
5. Fred explained the background of the Freenode controversy. Fred will move #erlang and #erlounge channels to the Libera network and would like to give a heads up to coordinate moving pointers from e.g. erlang.org to the new location.
6. Bryan presented proposal for blogging project from the marketing working group (attached). No developer decided on yet. The proposal is presented to get a budget for the project approved and detailed proposal will follow. Alternatives to current implementation proposal have been discussed, but it seems like the approach is the best - for most people (forestry.io example).

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the budget of up to \$4000 to spend on implementing the blogg post support as described in the proposal. Unanimously approved.

7. Stipend Proposals

1. Update Wrangler and add support for the Language Server protocol. Supervised by Simon Thompson. Amount \$3700. Presented by Peer. Questions: what is the relationship to refactorerl? That is a separate tool (the language server project has apparently reached out to both, but had not gotten an answer from refactorerl). The suggested working group is the building and packaging working group.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the stipend request for \$3700 to the project to update Wrangler as proposed. Unanimously approved.

2. PromEx proposal. Possible working group candidate is the observability working group. Sophie will sherpa the proposal, no vote taken.
3. Backend Platform in Elixir. Bryan will reach out and ask some sanity check questions.

8. Any other business.

1. Bryan brought up the situation regarding the marketing team. We need a goal - what is the purpose of the foundation - we need this to tell someone outside of the community why we exist. Also, the Nayra team needs a single point of contact on what to give priority (which is good news in a way, they are being asked to do more than they have time for). Bryan will create a repo where we can add issues for the marcom group. New members have joined the marketing working group, most notably Rose Burt who may be interested in stepping up and chair the group. Discussion around reaching out to companies in general and/or sponsor companies to ask them to help out. General consensus that it would be problematic to do so and allow companies to count contributed "hours" towards "logo on website" (i.e. instead of providing donations), that would open a big can of worms.

9. Alistair declared the meeting adjourned at 17:05 UTC.

Dated May 27, 2021

Secretary of the meeting: _____ Sebastian Strollo

Attachments:

1. Blogpost proposal (1 page)
2. Wrangler Update Development Stipend Request (2 pages)
3. PromEx project Stipend Request (2 page)
4. Backend Platform in Elixir... Stipend Request (1 page)

EEF blog post support

This document proposes funding for a project to add blog post support in the erlef app. The amount sought after is \$4,000.00 and shall not exceed said amount. This document does not go into specifications for the project, but will give a rough overview of the current process.

Current process

1. Clone the erlef app repo
2. Install postgresql and configure
3. Install javascript dependencies via npm
4. Install erlang and elixir dependencies via mix
5. Create your blog post under priv/posts
6. Add images and other static assets to the repository you will use in your post
7. Start up the app
8. Review your post
9. Make changes, probably have to restart the app to view them
10. Rinse, wash and repeat 7 - 9 until satisfied
11. Open a pull request
12. Wait for someone to review, approve, and merge your pull request
13. Wait on someone to perform a deployment of the app

That's the happy path. If you have to make fixups, you at the very least must go through step 11 - 13 again. You may be blocked on 12 or 13 and your fixups may need to get in quick, but possibly will not. Obviously this is suboptimal. The barrier to entry is too high, especially for non-devs. The mountain to climb vs the reward is not worth it. Further, if someone does have material who isn't a dev, typically they will reach out to a dev to get the material in, having a middle person in also sub-optimal and yet another blocker.

The marketing working group met and discussed said would-be project on Wed, May, 26th, 2021. All attending unanimously agreed that this project is a high priority for the marketing working group, other working groups, boards members, and members in general.

Stipend Proposal

Stipend Type : Development Work

First name : Simon

Last Name : Thompson

Nick Name : SJT

Email Address : s.j.thompson@kent.ac.uk

Phone Number : +447986085754

Organization Name : ELTE / University of Kent

City : Budapest

Region :

Postal Code : 1117

Country : Hungary

Twitter : thompson_si

Linkedin : simonthompson

Website : <https://www.kent.ac.uk/computing/people/3164/thomp>

Intended product of project :

This proposal is to update Wrangler, and to add it to the Erlang Language Server project.

Purpose

This will allow facilities from Wrangler to be re-available to existing users, and to open up usage to all editors and IDEs that support LSP in a sustainable way.

Development Plan

Please see attached PDF

Dissemination : Through an open source repo, but also via a talk or talks at developer conferences.

Delivery Method : Please see attached PDF

Stipend Amount (USD) : 3700

Payment Method : Wire

Wrangler 202x

Update Wrangler refactoring tool for Erlang and add to Erlang LS.

Background

Wrangler is a fully-featured refactoring tool providing

- A range of common refactorings, including renaming various program components, introducing new functions by “extracting” them from existing code, code inlining (function unfolding) and function folding, function generalisation, and so on.
- Some features are offered in interactive formats, allowing users to pick which instances at which (e.g.) code is inlined from the set of all possible inlining sites.
- Clone detection and elimination facilities.
- Extension points: an API for defining new refactorings from scratch, using Erlang code templates, and a DSL for scripting complex refactorings using existing ones.
- Program visualisation features, including call graphs, identifying circular module inclusions, for instance.

Wrangler has been integrated with Emacs and Eclipse (ErlIDE). Wrangler also provides a set of behaviours that embody refactoring workflows, and support integration with editors and IDEs. Wrangler works with OTP 21, but some features preclude its use with more recent systems, including use of e.g. `get_stacktrace` which is no longer available, and some other issues with Distel.

Proposal

This proposal is to update Wrangler, and to add it to the Erlang Language Server project. This will allow facilities from Wrangler to be re-available to existing users, and to open up usage to all editors and IDEs that support LSP in a sustainable way.

The first phase of the work will plan and execute migration of the code base to OTP 24. Including getting up to speed with the codebase, this is estimated to take 1 person month.

Wrangler will then be migrated to ELS in an iterative way, planned over 2 months in four fortnightly sprints. This will begin with migrating core refactoring functionality, and then examine ways in which the features noted above – interactivity, clone detection, extensibility, visualisation – can be migrated.

Details

- The project deliverables will be
 - The code developed in the Wrangler github repository.
 - Overview document, architecture description and API documentation
 - “How to” for future maintainers and contributors.
 - Presentation of the work to a suitable developer conference.
- Costing: €3000k @ €1000k/month; pay for full or part-time student developer.
- Supervisory team: Simon Thompson (Kent/ELTE), Huiqing Li (BT), Dániel Horpácsi (ELTE).

Stipend Proposal

Stipend Type : Development Work

First name : Alexander

Last Name : Koutmos

Nick Name :

Email Address : akoutmos@gmail.com

Phone Number : (203) 512-5822

Organization Name :

City : East Hampton

Region : CT

Postal Code : 06424

Country : United States

Twitter : @akoutmos

Linkedin : <https://www.linkedin.com/in/alex-koutmos-b8b2bb93/>

Website : <https://akoutmos.com/>

Intended product of project :

The PromEx project (https://github.com/akoutmos/prom_ex) aims to provide a turn key observability solution for Elixir applications (Prometheus metrics and Grafana dashboards in less than 5 minutes to be exact ;)). It does so by leveraging the community Telemetry tooling to provide Prometheus metrics and Grafana dashboards for community libraries such as Phoenix, LiveView, Ecto, Oban, and even the BEAM itself.

Purpose

The reason for this stipend request is to aid in the development of the PromEx library that is published on Hex (https://hex.pm/packages/prom_ex). There are currently a few big items on the upcoming feature list that will greatly improve the observability experience for all Elixir applications and in particular applications running on Gigalixir/Heroku/ECS. This would be in addition to providing dashboards for other open source Elixir projects like Broadway, Absinthe and Finch. Specifically, the goals that would be achievable with this stipend would be: - Prometheus metrics and a Grafana dashboard for Absinthe (<https://hex.pm/packages/absinthe>) - Prometheus metrics and a Grafana dashboard for Finch (<https://hex.pm/packages/finch>) - Packaging of GrafanaAgent in PromEx so that library users can push metrics to Prometheus instances (https://github.com/akoutmos/prom_ex/issues/44) - Completion of the Broadway PromEx plugin and Grafana dashboard (https://github.com/akoutmos/prom_ex/pull/39)

Development Plan

The goal would be to finish and deliver the aforementioned features in the next 6 weeks, with development all being done by myself. With a stipend from the EEF, I could forego any kind of consulting work for the next 6 weeks, which will free up my time to focus on this open source library. The breakdown of time would be as follows: - 3 weeks on

integrating the GrafanaAgent - 1 week for the Absinthe PromEx plugin - 1 week for the Broadway PromEx plugin - 1 week for the Finch PromEx plugin

Dissemination : As features are completed, I will be posting updates on my Twitter account, my blog and perhaps later this year, I will give another conference talk on the project to let the community know how it is evolving since my last Code BEAM V America presentation.

Delivery Method : As features reach completion, new versions of PromEx will be published to Hex and will be announced on all the platforms where I have a presence.

Stipend Amount (USD) : 3500

Payment Method : Check

Stipend Proposal

Stipend Type : Development Work

First name : Vikash

Last Name : KHANNA

Nick Name :

Email Address : vcashk@gmail.com

Phone Number : +91-8050020532

Organization Name : United Lodge of Theosophists

City : Bengaluru

Region : Karnataka

Postal Code : 560034

Country : India

Twitter : vcashk

Intended product of project :

The United Lodge of Theosophists is a worldwide NGO and non profit organization which aims at furtherance of peace, harmony and universal brotherhood. The main product is a Backend Platform in Elixir exposing API's for the mobile application and the website.

Purpose

There are many branches of United Lodge of Theosophists around the world and close to 50K users. The product is a mobile application backed by an ELIXIR based platform API's to collaborate and aggregate information, data, events and conferences. This all needs to be done in real time and having a huge concurrent base needs the Elixir / BEAM based solution

Development Plan

I am a long standing member of ULT and also have 21yrs experience in IT. I will be leading this project by getting few more developers on board. Currently the scope has been defined and the initial scaffolding code in Phoenix has been updated. Plus a basic mobile android app code has been generated.

Dissemination : We have a 50 K user base around the world and will use the various channels ie. our websites and Elixir conferences, talks to showcase the platform. This will help us to also bring more people on our platform. Here are the links of some of our websites: <https://www.ultindia.org/> <https://www.theosophy-ult.org.uk/> <https://ult-la.org/> <https://universaltheosophy.com/>

Delivery Method : We are following Agile Scrum and can deliver the results of the project once in 3 weeks or as required by sharing a link to the GitHub and also showcasing the mobile app development demos as a video

Stipend Amount (USD) : 5000

Payment Method : Wire